Data Retention and Privacy

This document explains what personal data Harbor Goods keeps, how long we keep it, and how customers can ask us to delete it. It covers customer data and the contact details of supplier staff held in our systems.

What we collect

We collect the data needed to take and deliver orders: name, delivery and billing address, email address, phone number, order history and messages with support. Harbor Goods never stores full payment card numbers. Card details are handled by our payment processor, and we keep only the last four digits and the card type for each order.

Retention periods

Order records, including invoices and payment records, are kept for 7 years after the end of the financial year in which the order was placed, to meet tax and accounting rules. Customer account data is kept while the account is active and is deleted after 24 months without a login or an order. Support tickets and chat transcripts are kept for 3 years after the ticket is closed. Marketing consent records are kept for 5 years after the customer withdraws consent, so that we can prove what was agreed. Warehouse security camera footage is kept for 30 days unless it is needed for an investigation.

Deletion requests

Customers can ask Harbor Goods to delete their personal data by using the privacy request form in their account or by writing to support. We verify the identity of the person making the request within 5 business days, usually by a code sent to the email address on the account. Once the identity is verified, we complete the deletion within 30 days and send a confirmation email.

Some data cannot be deleted on request. Order records that we must keep for tax purposes are kept for the rest of their 7 year period, but the name and contact details on them are replaced with a reference number where the law allows. Data needed for an open chargeback, warranty claim or legal claim is kept until that matter is closed.

Marketing emails

Customers can unsubscribe from marketing emails at any time with the unsubscribe option at the bottom of each email. Unsubscribe requests take effect within 2 business days. Order and shipping emails are still sent because they are needed to deliver the order.

Backups

Backups of the order and customer systems are kept for 35 days. Data deleted from the live systems disappears from backups when the backups that hold it expire, so a deletion is complete in every system no later than 35 days after it is made in the live system.

Access and security

Staff can see customer data only when their role needs it. Access rights are reviewed every quarter by the Operations Manager. If a data breach affects customer data, the incident lead informs management within 24 hours of discovery, and affected customers are told without undue delay.

Data sharing

We share delivery details with NorthRoute Parcel and Swiftline Freight to deliver orders, and payment details with our payment processor. Harbor Goods does not sell customer data to anyone.